

Question 21 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the structure of an HRD system and describe its major components.

Answer

An HRD system is an integrated set of subsystems and processes designed to develop individuals, dyads, teams and the organisation. Structure means how these parts are arranged and linked, not a mere list of training courses.

- 1. HRD philosophy and goals:** The foundation—beliefs about people and the aims of development.
- 2. Performance appraisal:** Periodic assessment used for development (strengths, gaps, goals), not only for rewards.
- 3. Potential appraisal:** Assessment of future capability for higher or different roles.
- 4. Training and development:** Planned learning to close gaps and prepare for future work.
- 5. Career planning and development:** Matching individual aspirations with organisational paths.
- 6. Feedback and counselling:** Dialogue that turns appraisal data into insight and action.
- 7. OD and climate mechanisms:** Team building, culture work, employee surveys—system-level development.
- 8. Supporting structure:** HRD staff, line-manager roles, information system, and links to HRM (rewards, placement). Components must be interrelated so data from one feeds another.

***Conclusion.** A well-structured HRD system is therefore a network of subsystems around a developmental philosophy, not isolated HR activities.*